

Italian White Sauce Pasta (Fettuccine Alfredo)

Italian white sauce pasta, famously known as Fettuccine Alfredo, is a classic and elegant dish. It features pasta, traditionally fettuccine, coated in a rich and creamy sauce made from butter, Parmesan cheese, and heavy cream.

It's a simple yet luxurious dish, beloved for its comforting and decadent flavor.

Keep reading below to find a classic recipe for white sauce pasta - smooth, creamy, and perfectly rich, made with simple ingredients for an authentic Italian-American experience.

Recipe

Prep Time:	Cook Time:	Serves:
10 minutes	15 minutes	4 people

Ingredients

For the Pasta

- 400g Fettuccine pasta
- Salt for boiling water

For the White Sauce (Alfredo Sauce)

- $\frac{1}{2}$ cup (115g) unsalted butter
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- $1\frac{1}{2}$ cups (360 ml) heavy cream
- $1\frac{1}{2}$ cups freshly grated Parmesan cheese
- Salt and black pepper, to taste
- 2 tbsp fresh parsley, chopped (for garnish)
- A pinch of nutmeg (optional)

Instructions

1. Cook the Pasta

1. Bring a large pot of salted water to a rolling boil.
2. Add the fettuccine and cook according to package directions until *al dente* (firm to the bite).
3. Before draining, reserve about 1 cup of the pasta water. Drain the pasta.

2. Prepare the White Sauce

1. In a large skillet or pan, melt the butter over medium heat.
2. Add the minced garlic and sauté for about 1 minute until fragrant. Do not let it brown.
3. Slowly pour in the heavy cream, whisking gently. Bring the mixture to a simmer and let it cook for 3-4 minutes, allowing it to thicken slightly.

4. Reduce the heat to low and gradually whisk in the grated Parmesan cheese until the sauce is smooth and creamy.
5. Season with salt, black pepper, and a pinch of nutmeg (if using).

3. Combine and Serve

1. Add the drained pasta directly to the skillet with the white sauce.
2. Toss everything together until the pasta is thoroughly coated. If the sauce is too thick, add a splash of the reserved pasta water to reach your desired consistency.
3. Garnish with fresh parsley and an extra sprinkle of Parmesan cheese.
4. Serve immediately.

Serving Tip

Serve hot, paired with grilled chicken or shrimp for added protein. It also goes wonderfully with a side of steamed vegetables, a fresh green salad, or crusty garlic bread to soak up the delicious sauce. A glass of crisp white wine, like Pinot Grigio, complements the dish perfectly.